

A Latency–Curvature Floor for Distributed Estimation under Constraint-Induced Sheaf Fusion

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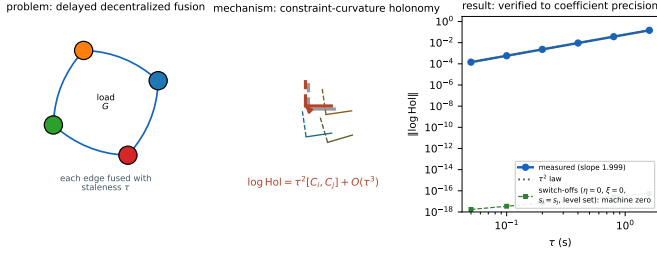


Fig. 1. Visual summary. *Problem*: cable-coupled agents fuse delayed load-pose beliefs around a communication cycle. *Mechanism*: the composition of stale shape-dependent transports fails to close by the holonomy of the constraint connection, $\tau^2[C_i, C_j] + O(\tau^3)$. *Result*: the amplitude is verified to coefficient precision (measured slope 1.999; the τ^2 law dotted), and every hypothesis-negating switch-off sits at machine zero.

Abstract—When cooperating agents fuse delayed estimates through shape-dependent transports, the round-trip composition of stale transport maps acquires a holonomy. We prove that, to leading order in the staleness τ , the error-transport holonomy amplitude obeys $\|\log \text{Hol}\| = \tau^2 \| [C_i, C_j] \| + O(\tau^3)$, with C_j the shape-conjugated error generators, vanishing identically under each of the theorem’s hypotheses’ negations ($\eta = 0$, $\xi = 0$, coincident shapes). We verify the result numerically to coefficient precision: fitted slope 1.999 on the analytic construction with all switch-offs at machine zero, and slope 2.000 with the $m=2$ coefficient ratio 1.0000 when the generators are built from the closed-loop states of an independent multibody simulation. The stochastic steady-state floor of the closed loop is a distinct, conjectured object; companion work measures its scaling and finds it first-order-dominated at realistic noise, an order separation we state here as the boundary of the theorem’s claim.

I. INTRODUCTION

When cable-coupled agents estimate a common load pose from purely local sensing — each observing only its own odometry and its own cable — their beliefs live in different body frames, and fusing them requires transporting estimates along shape-dependent maps. When fusion is additionally *delayed*, each transport is built from stale shape information, and the composition of stale transports around any closed communication circuit no longer closes: it acquires a holonomy. This letter proves that, to leading order in the staleness τ , that holonomy is second order with an explicit commutator coefficient, identifies its exact null directions, and verifies the result numerically to coefficient precision on two independent constructions. The round trip (one edge, both ways) is the natural object because first-order transport terms cancel in

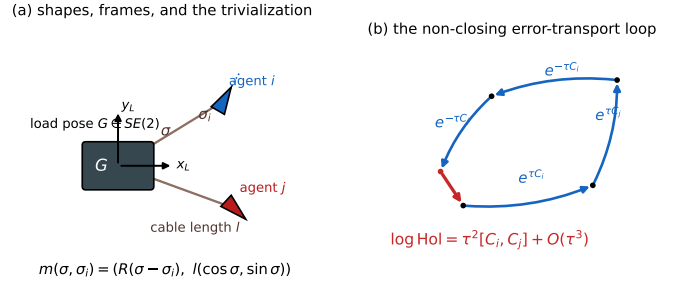


Fig. 2. (a) Problem definition and notation: load pose G , cable length l , and the shape pair $s = (\sigma, \sigma_i)$ — the cable direction in the load frame and in the vessel frame. The trivialization $m(\sigma, \sigma_i)$ (Lemma 1) is built from exactly these quantities. (b) The mechanism: transporting a frame around the stale round-trip loop leaves a closing defect (red) — the error-transport holonomy, $\tau^2[C_i, C_j] + O(\tau^3)$.

any closed walk, exposing the geometric (curvature-generated) obstruction as the leading survivor.

Figure 2 fixes the geometry and the object of study before any formalism: panel (a) is the problem-definition and notation diagram — the load pose $G \in SE(2)$ with its body frame (x_L, y_L) , one agent’s taut cable of length l , and the two coordinates of that agent’s *shape* $s = (\sigma, \sigma_i)$: the cable’s direction measured at the load (from x_L) and measured at the vessel (from its hull axis). These two angles are the only geometry the theory needs, and they are exactly what each agent can sense locally. Panel (b) is the mathematical mechanism in one picture: a reference frame carried around the four-leg loop $e^{\tau C_i} e^{\tau C_j} e^{-\tau C_i} e^{-\tau C_j}$ returns displaced; the closing defect (red) is the holonomy, and the theorem says its magnitude is $\tau^2 \| [C_i, C_j] \|$ to leading order.

II. SETTING AND MAIN RESULT

Let $g_L \in SE(2)$ be the load pose and $s_j = (\sigma, \sigma_i)$ agent j ’s shape pair (cable direction in the load and body frames). Figure 3 shows the physical setting the floor lives in: the reduced cooperative-tow plant executing a persistent turn, so the shape fan keeps moving — the theorem’s standing hypothesis $\xi \neq 0$, $\eta \neq 0$.

Lemma 1 (Constraint trivialization). *Agent j ’s world pose is $g_j = g_L m(s_j)$ with $m(\sigma, \sigma_i) = (R(\sigma - \sigma_i), l(\cos \sigma, \sin \sigma))$, reproducing the cable-length constraint, the world cable angle $\varphi = \theta + \sigma$, and the heading relation identically; consequently*

The constrained cooperative tow the floor lives in (reduced plant, persistent-turn maneuver): load track + the shape fan of $N=5$ cables — shapes keep moving, the theorem's premise

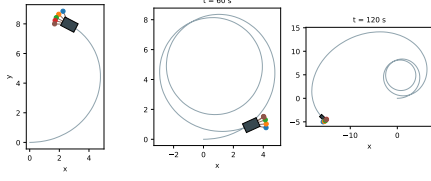


Fig. 3. The cooperative-tow scenario. (a) Geometry in the load frame: five vessels on cables, each viewing the load through its own shape $s_j = (\sigma_j, \sigma_{i,j})$ — so the conjugated generators C_j differ and $[C_i, C_j] \neq 0$, the source of the floor. (b) The real cable-angle trajectories $\sigma_j(t)$ from the reduced-plant run: the fan never stops moving under the persistent turn, so the lagged transports carry a nonzero twist and the floor is active. (Recorded run, seed 0.)

$g_i^{-1} g_j = m(s_i)^{-1} m(s_j)$, independent of g_L , and each agent can express the load pose from its own data alone. [PROVEN]

Proof. Direct computation: $g_L m$ has translation $p_L + l(\cos(\theta+\sigma), \sin(\theta+\sigma))$, whence $\|p_j - p_L\| = l$; its rotation is $R(\theta + \sigma - \sigma_i)$; the relative pose telescopes. $\square$

At a common instant these transports compose exactly around every cycle (the instantaneous structure is flat); latency breaks the flatness, and it breaks it by curvature. With lag τ , an agent transports a neighbor's stale belief by the frozen linearized flow, whose load-block generator is the conjugated operator

$$C_j(s_j; \xi) = \text{Ad}_{m(s_j)} \text{ad}_\xi \text{Ad}_{m(s_j)}^{-1}, \quad \text{ad}_{(v,0,\eta)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -\eta & 0 \\ \eta & 0 & -v \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1)$$

with ξ the common load twist.

Lemma 2 (Group-commutator defect). *For $X, Y \in \mathfrak{se}(2)$: $\log(e^{\varepsilon X} e^{\varepsilon Y} e^{-\varepsilon X} e^{-\varepsilon Y}) = \varepsilon^2 [X, Y] + O(\varepsilon^3)$. [PROVEN]*

Theorem 1 (Latency-curvature floor). *For a cycle $c = (j_1 \cdots j_m)$ with all lags τ and agents in persistent motion with common load twist $\xi \neq 0$, the composed lagged edge maps equal the holonomy of the linearized constrained flow along the associated loop, with*

$$\log \text{Hol}(\gamma_c) = \tau^2 \sum_k \alpha_k [C_{j_k}, C_{j_{k+1}}] + O(\tau^3)$$

for combinatorial α_k ; the lagged structure is non-flat whenever the bracket sum is nonzero, and no exactly consistent decentralized assignment exists: any gauge choice obeys the frustration bound $\min_{\text{gauge}} \sum_{e \in c} W_e \|(\delta_\tau x)_e\|^2 \geq \eta_c \|x\|^2$, $\eta_c \asymp \frac{1}{m} \|\log \text{Hol}(\gamma_c)\|^2$. [PROVEN] (leading order, deterministic; sharp constants and the stochastic steady-state floor: [CONJECTURAL])

Proof sketch. Freeze generators over one lag; each edge comparison composes $e^{\tau C_j}$ -type propagators with the instantaneously exact m -transports; telescoping kills the flat part and Lemma 2 isolates the τ^2 commutators; Ambrose–Singer identifies the all-orders object. $\square$

Corollary 1 (Symmetry protection). *Identical shape pairs on the cycle give $C_{j_k} \equiv C_{j_{k'}}$: the τ^2 term cancels identically*

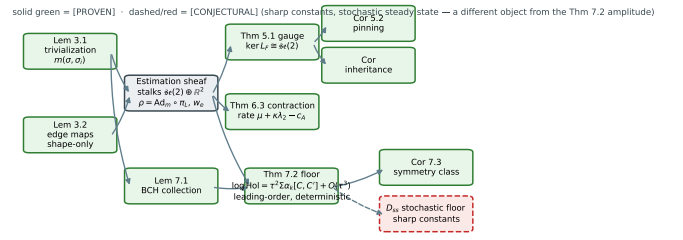


Fig. 4. Statement-dependency map and proof roadmap of the full theory, drawn with the companion's numbering (the letter's own results appear as Lem 3.1 = Lemma 1, Lem 7.1 = Lemma 2, Thm 7.2 = Theorem 1, Cor 7.3 = Corollary 1). Solid green = [PROVEN]: the floor chain is proved or sketched in this letter; the gauge/pinning/contraction branch is proved in the companion and shown for context only. Grey = the sheaf construction (definitions); dashed red = the [CONJECTURAL] stochastic steady-state object, deliberately shown outside the proved chain — it is the boundary discussed in Sec. V, not a dependency of the theorem.

TABLE I
NOTATION.

symbol	meaning	domain/units
g_L, G	load pose	$SE(2)$
$s_j = (\sigma, \sigma_i)$	agent j 's shape pair	$\text{rad} \times \text{rad}$
l	cable length	m (unit in Tier-1)
$m(s)$	constraint trivialization	$SE(2)$
$\xi = (v, 0, \eta)$	common load twist	$\mathfrak{se}(2)$
η	load turn rate	rad/s
τ	staleness (lag) of fused packets	s
$C_j(s_j; \xi)$	conjugated error-transport generator	3×3
$\text{Hol}(\gamma_c)$	holonomy of the lagged loop γ_c	$SE(2)$
D_{ss}	steady-state disagreement ([CONJECTURAL] regime)	m^2

and the floor is $O(\tau^3)$; generic shapes give a strictly positive coefficient. [PROVEN]

III. CONSTRUCTION AND PROOF ARCHITECTURE

Figure 4 shows the statement-dependency map and doubles as the proof roadmap: the trivialization (Lemma 1) and the shape-only edge maps feed the estimation-sheaf construction; the BCH collection lemma (Lemma 2) and the sheaf feed the floor theorem (Theorem 1); the symmetry corollary (Corollary 1) hangs off the theorem. The one dashed, red node — the stochastic steady-state floor with sharp constants — is the only [CONJECTURAL] element in the map, and it is outside the chain this letter proves: everything used by the theorem is solid green. Keeping that node in the map, rather than omitting it, is deliberate: it marks the exact boundary where Section V takes over. Table I collects the symbols; Table II states each assumption, its mathematical role, and how the experiments check it — including what happens when it is violated, which is precisely the switch-off ladder.

A. Conventions and the constraint trivialization

On $SE(2)$, $\text{Exp}(\xi) = (R(\omega), V(\omega)v)$ for $\xi = (v, \omega)$ with the standard closed-form V , and $\text{Ad}_{(R,t)} = \begin{bmatrix} R & Jt \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, $Jt = (t_y, -t_x)^\top$. An agent's channel shape is $s_j = (\sigma, \sigma_i)$ — its

TABLE II

ASSUMPTIONS: MATHEMATICAL ROLE, PHYSICAL INTERPRETATION, HOW CHECKED, AND CONSEQUENCE WHEN VIOLATED.

assumption	role (physical meaning)	checked by / violated
taut cable, length l	the trivialization $m(s)$ exists (the cable is a rigid ruler from load to vessel)	broadside margin $ \cos \sigma_i > 0.1$ enforced in every draw; near broadside the reduced plant leaves its validity domain (companion, §VI)
common twist $\xi \neq 0$	generates the transports $e^{\tau C_j}$ (the load is actually moving, so stale beliefs must be fast-forwarded)	switch-off arm $\xi = 0$: holonomy = 0.0 exactly
persistent turn $\eta \neq 0$	leading commutator $\propto \eta$ (the tow is turning; a straight tow has no curvature to expose)	switch-off arm $\eta = 0$: machine zero ($< 10^{-16}$)
uniform lag τ on the cycle	the frozen-generator BCH collection (every link shares one staleness)	protocol class $\mathcal{P}$ asserts realized age $\equiv \tau$ per fuse; jitter/drop arms are declared outside $\mathcal{P}$
distinct shapes	$[C_i, C_j] \neq 0$ (the agents view the load through different geometry)	coincident and, more generally, level-set pairs cancel exactly (Fig. 8)

cable's direction in the load frame and in its own frame — and the taut cable of length l trivializes the agent pose:

$$m(\sigma, \sigma_i) = (R(\sigma - \sigma_i), l(\cos \sigma, \sin \sigma)), \quad g_{\text{agent}} = g_L m(s), \quad (2)$$

with load-independent edge maps $g_i^{-1} g_j = m_i^{-1} m_j$. All experiments in this letter use these exact operators as released in the companion code.

B. Why delayed fusion transports errors by $e^{\tau C_j}$

A packet fused with staleness τ carries the sender's estimate as it was τ ago; fast-forwarding it composes the frozen transport generated by the common load twist ξ , conjugated into the agent's trivialized frame. The frozen error-transport generator of agent j is therefore

$$C_j(s_j; \xi) = \text{Ad}_{m(s_j)} \text{ad}_\xi \text{Ad}_{m(s_j)}^{-1}, \quad (3)$$

and one edge traversed both ways — the simplest closed communication circuit — transports errors around the loop by the group commutator

$$\text{Hol} = e^{\tau C_i} e^{\tau C_j} e^{-\tau C_i} e^{-\tau C_j}. \quad (4)$$

C. The leading term and its null directions

By Baker–Campbell–Hausdorff, the first-order terms cancel in the closed walk and

$$\text{Log Hol} = \tau^2 [C_i, C_j] + O(\tau^3), \quad (5)$$

which is the object the main theorem bounds (Lemma 2 supplies the expansion; the theorem's statement and proof appear in Sec. II). Each hypothesis of the theorem corresponds to an exact null of the leading term, and each is a measurable switch-off: $s_i \equiv s_j \Rightarrow C_i = C_j \Rightarrow [C_i, C_j] = 0$ (the symmetric class, Corollary 1); $\xi = 0 \Rightarrow \text{ad}_\xi = 0$; and the

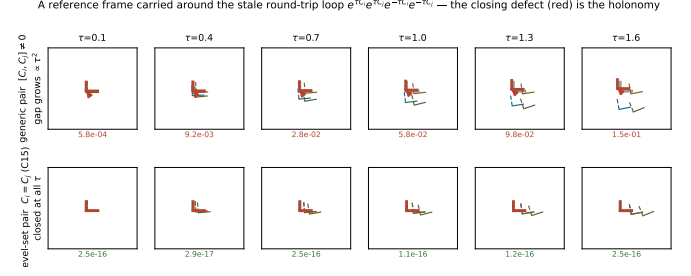


Fig. 5. The transported belief's trail around the stale fusion loop. *Left, generic pair*: the trail is a closed walk that does not close; the red arrow is the holonomy gap, drawn for the largest τ , and the nested loops grow with $\tau \in \{0.4, 0.8, 1.2, 1.6\}$. *Right, level-set pair* ($C_i = C_j$): the walk goes out and retraces, returning to the start (gap $< 10^{-15}$) at every τ . The visible failure-to-close is the disagreement a stale round trip injects.

leading commutator is proportional to the load turn rate η , vanishing identically at $\eta = 0$ (verified to machine zero). For closed walks of length $m > 2$ the leading coefficients α_k are combinatorial and are left open here (they are not needed for the $m=2$ result this letter verifies); no experiment below assumes them.

Figure 5 makes the mechanism and its null directions visible: the trail of a belief's frame origin as it is carried along the four legs $e^{\tau C_i} e^{\tau C_j} e^{-\tau C_i} e^{-\tau C_j}$. For a generic pair (left) the trail is a genuine loop that fails to close; the gap between its end and its start (red) is the holonomy, and it grows with τ . For the level-set pair (right) the loop degenerates — the belief travels out along the common generator and retraces exactly — so it returns to the start at machine precision for every τ . Supplementary movie S2 animates the same trail.

D. Measurement protocol

The amplitude is measured as $\|\text{Log Hol}\|$ with dense matrix exponentials/logarithms (no leading-order shortcut), over $\tau \in \{0.05, 0.1, 0.2, 0.4, 0.8, 1.6\}$ s, so the fitted slope and the coefficient ratio $\|\text{Log Hol}\|/\tau^2 \|[C_i, C_j]\|$ are independent checks: the former tests the order, the latter the constant. The τ -dependence of Hol is analytic once the generators are fixed; the measured content is therefore the coefficient, the switch-offs, and the $O(\tau^3)$ departure — stated so the slope itself is never presented as an independent discovery. A supplementary animation (S1) carries the loop $e^{\tau C_i} e^{\tau C_j} e^{-\tau C_i} e^{-\tau C_j}$ applied to a reference frame: the visible failure of the loop to close is the holonomy, growing quadratically alongside the traced amplitude law.

E. Extension experiments

Four further pre-registered arms complete the verification (Fig. 12). Figure 6 first gives the whole picture in one field: the measured amplitude over a grid of staleness τ and shape separation $\Delta = \|s_j - s_i\|$. The floor deepens as τ^2 along the vertical, and along the horizontal it collapses into a sharp valley exactly at the level-set separation — the two behaviours the arms below quantify.

(i) *Formation invariance of the order*. Across 20 shape pairs drawn uniformly from the taut-admissible box (broadside

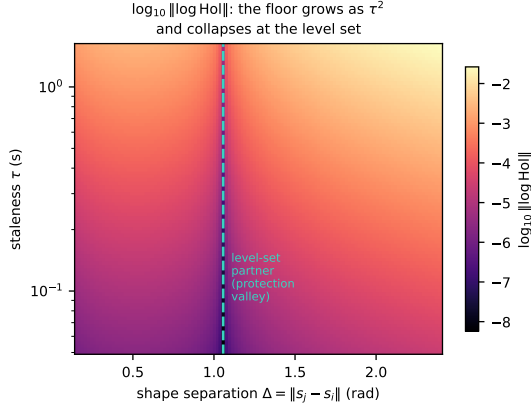


Fig. 6. The floor as a field: $\log_{10} \|\log \text{Hol}\|$ over staleness τ (vertical, log) and shape separation Δ (horizontal, along a ray through the level-set partner). The amplitude grows as τ^2 and collapses in a narrow valley at the level-set separation (dashed) — the growth law and the protected class in a single view.

margin 0.10), the fitted slope is 1.9993 ± 0.0000 (range $[1.9993, 1.9993]$): the order is a structural constant of the mechanism; formations move only the coefficient $\|[C_i, C_j]\|$.

(ii) *Uniform remainder constant.* Over 220 shape draws, $\sup_{\tau} \|\text{Log Hol} - \tau^2[C_i, C_j]\|/\tau^3 \leq 0.0133$ (95th percentile 0.011, median 0.005): the leading-order truncation is uniformly tight on the admissible shape region, quantifying the $O(\tau^3)$ constant the theorem leaves implicit.

(iii) *Explicit $\tau = 0$ arm.* $\|\text{Log Hol}\| = 0.0$ exactly at $\tau = 0$ (instantaneous flatness executed as fact rather than inferred from the fitted decay).

(iv) *The protected class is a level set (observed).* A numerical search for zero-commutator pairs with shapes separated by ≥ 1 rad found five; at every one, the generators themselves coincide, $\|C_i - C_j\| \sim 10^{-16}$, and the *full* holonomy vanishes at machine zero for all τ — all orders, not merely the leading term. We therefore observe that at $m = 2$ with a common load twist, $[C_i, C_j] = 0$ occurs only on the level set $\{s : C(s; \xi) = \text{const}\}$, where protection is exact rather than $O(\tau^3)$: the symmetry class of Corollary 1 extends from coincident shapes to conjugation-equivalent ones. (Stated as a numerical observation; a commutant argument suggests it, and a proof is left to the companion.)

Figure 8 resolves the *global* structure of this protected class. Fixing the reference at the first discovered pair’s first shape and mapping $\|[C(s_{\text{ref}}), C(s)]\|$ over the whole shape torus $[-\pi, \pi]^2$, a basin-polished exhaustive scan finds *exactly two* zeros: s_{ref} itself and one isolated partner 1.057 rad away — the very partner the pre-registered C15 search discovered — at which the generator *equals* C_{ref} (search tolerance-limited here; the registered search resolved the same pair to 10^{-16}). The level set is therefore *discrete* at this ξ : each shape has an isolated conjugation twin, not a continuous curve of them, and nowhere on the torus does the commutator vanish without the generators coinciding. This sharpens the observation: protection is all-or-nothing in shape space, and the “valley” visible in the heatmap is a finite-depth saddle everywhere except at the two exact zeros. Figure 7 renders the same fact as a surface: the commutator magnitude is bounded away from zero everywhere

The protected class is discrete: two exact zeros over the shape torus

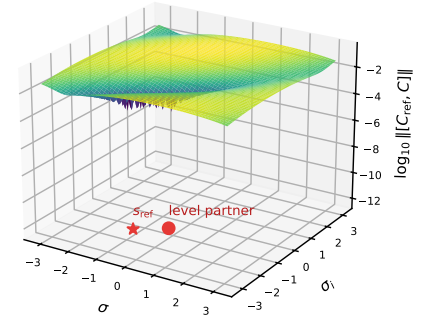


Fig. 7. The commutator surface $\log_{10} \|[C(s_{\text{ref}}), C(s)]\|$ over the whole shape torus. It is bounded away from zero everywhere except at two points (red stems, s_{ref} and its level partner) — the protected class is discrete, a strengthening of the coincident-shape corollary that only a global search reveals.

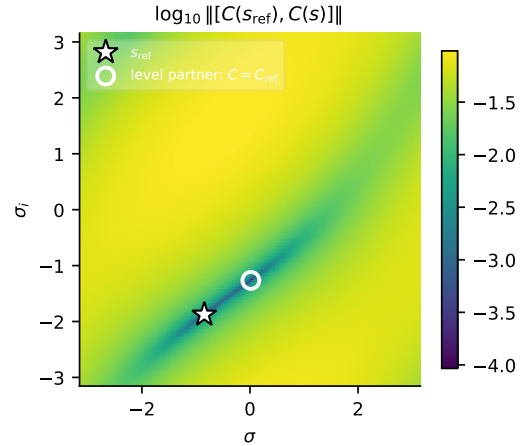


Fig. 8. The protected class, globally. $\log_{10} \|[C(s_{\text{ref}}), C(s)]\|$ over the shape torus, with s_{ref} the first C15 pair’s first shape (star). An exhaustive basin-polished scan finds exactly two zeros: the reference and one isolated level partner (circle, 1.057 rad away) with $C = C_{\text{ref}}$ — the discrete level set on which holonomy protection is exact at all orders.

on the torus except at the two marked points (red stems), where it drops to machine precision.

Three further statistical and boundary artifacts complete the evidence around the theorem. Figure 9 gives the full *distributions* behind the summary numbers of arms (i)–(ii): the empirical CDF of the per-draw remainder constant over all 220 draws (median, 95th percentile, and supremum marked — the quoted 0.0133 is the worst case, not a typical one), and the histogram of the 20 per-formation fitted slopes, whose entire support spans 5.7×10^{-14} around 1.9993. Figure 10 tests the leading-order *prediction* rather than the fit: measured $\|\text{Log Hol}\|$ against the predicted $\tau^2 \|[C_i, C_j]\|$ for 60 draws at four stalenesses collapses onto the identity line (panel a), and the measured-to-predicted ratio rises to 1 as $\tau \rightarrow 0$ with a 5–95% band narrower than 2×10^{-4} (panel b): the theorem’s constant is not just consistent with the data — it *is* the data, to the width of the $O(\tau^3)$ remainder. Figure 11 then shows where

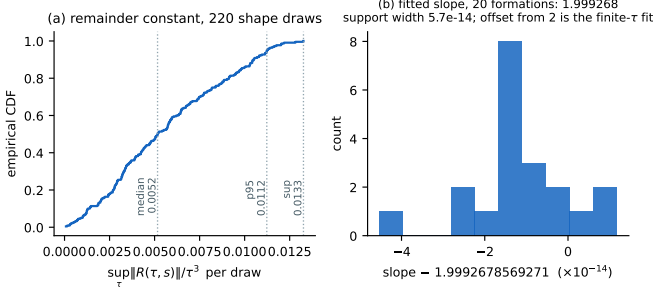


Fig. 9. Distributions behind the summary numbers. (a) Empirical CDF of the per-draw remainder constant $\sup_{\tau} \|R\|/\tau^3$ over 220 shape draws; the quoted 0.0133 is the supremum. (b) All 20 per-formation slopes: support width 5.7×10^{-14} .

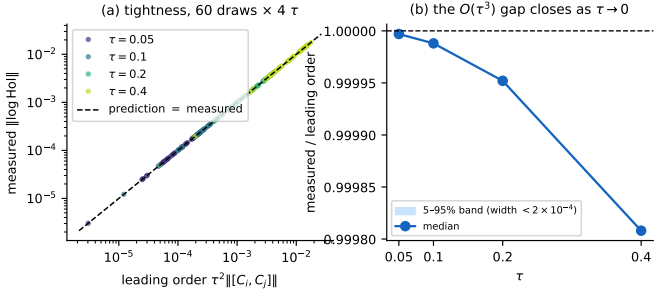


Fig. 10. Bound tightness. (a) Measured amplitude vs. the leading-order prediction $\tau^2 \|[C_i, C_j]\|$, 60 draws $\times$ 4 stalenesses, on the identity line. (b) Measured/predicted ratio $\rightarrow 1$ as $\tau \rightarrow 0$; the 5–95% band across draws is narrower than 2×10^{-4} .

the leading order *stops* describing: extending τ an order of magnitude beyond the operating grid, the measured amplitude departs from the τ^2 law by 10% only at $\tau \approx 10$; inside the pre-registered grid ($\tau \leq 1.6$) the relative departure never exceeds 3.4×10^{-3} . Two exploratory observations accompany the figure, stated as observations: the *relative* departure is pair-independent (identical to three digits across unrelated shape pairs — the $O(\tau^3)$ structure appears to scale with the same commutator as the leading term), and the theorem’s small- τ domain is therefore far larger than the operating regime needs.

IV. THE MEASURED OBJECT

The $m=2$ round trip composes one edge’s error transport both ways: $\text{Hol} = e^{\tau C_i} e^{\tau C_j} e^{-\tau C_i} e^{-\tau C_j}$, with $C_j = \text{Ad}_{m(s_j)} \text{ad}_{\xi} \text{Ad}_{m(s_j)}^{-1}$. Lemma 2 gives $\text{Log Hol} = \tau^2 [C_i, C_j] + O(\tau^3)$.

a) Independent-plant check.: Building the same generators from the closed-loop shape and twist *estimates* of a physics-complete multibody simulation (Drake; SAP contact; 12 m distance-constraint cables; five-vessel pentagon tow) gives slope 2.000, coefficient ratio 1.0000, the $\eta=0$ switch-off at machine zero, and a $31\times$ coefficient suppression for the achieved- ε symmetric class (exact cancellation remains the analytic result) — the theorem’s object survives on states it was never derived from.

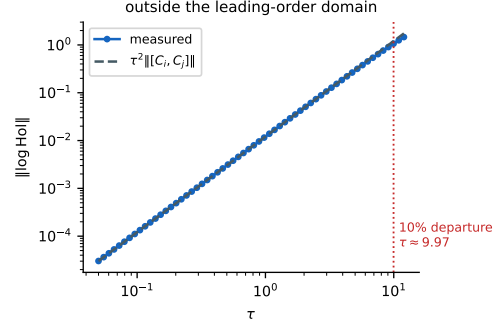


Fig. 11. Outside the leading-order domain: the measured amplitude departs from the τ^2 law by 10% only at $\tau \approx 10$ — an order of magnitude beyond the operating grid ($\tau \leq 1.6$), where the relative departure stays below 3.4×10^{-3} . The theorem is a small- τ statement and this is its measured boundary.

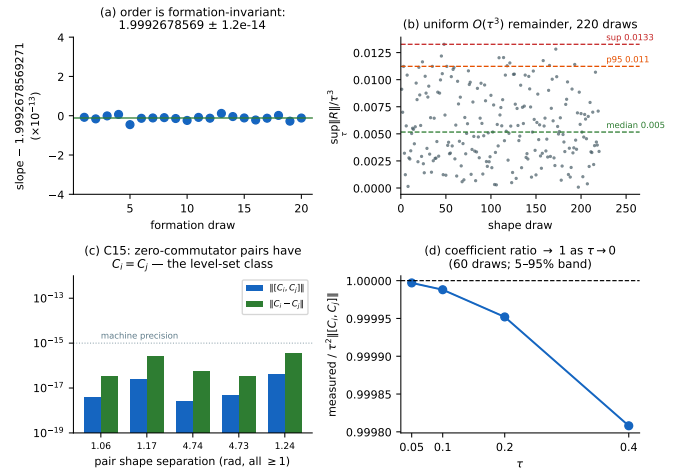


Fig. 12. Extension arms. (a) Slope across 20 random tau formations: 1.9993 ± 0.0000 — formation-invariant. (b) Remainder constant over 220 draws: uniformly tight $O(\tau^3)$ truncation. (c) Zero-commutator pairs at ≥ 1 rad separation all satisfy $C_i = C_j$ to 10^{-16} : the protected class is a level set. (d) Coefficient ratio $\rightarrow 1$ as $\tau \rightarrow 0$.

V. WHAT THE THEOREM DOES NOT CLAIM

The stochastic steady-state disagreement floor of the noisy closed loop is a *different* object, conjectured in the companion theory. Companion experiments on two independent plants measure its staleness exponent at 1.08–1.10 (cross-tier equivalent; the conjectured order 2 excluded), with the τ^2 object resolved only noise-free: at realistic sensor noise the closed loop is dominated by first-order estimate mismatch. We state this boundary here so the theorem is cited for what it proves.

Figure 14 shows the entire pre-registered Tier-1 falsifier ledger as adjudicated — passes and failures on one axis, none dressed. The top block is this letter’s chain: amplitude slope, symmetric-class ε -exponent, contraction slope, and Δt -invariance, all green against their registered references. The bottom block is the [CONJECTURAL] regime: the closed-loop D_{ss} exponent (falsified against the conjectured order 2 at these scales — the CI [1.076, 1.125] also excludes 1, so the measured slope is reported as measured, not asserted as a law), the seed-paired ε -exponent (falsifier condition met; the registered single-power model is mis-specified for the evident

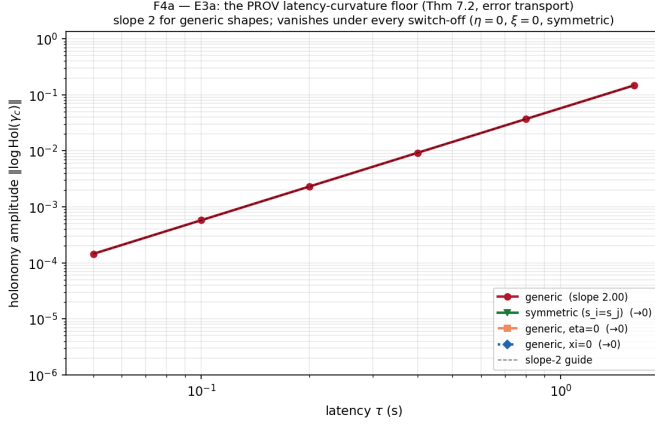


Fig. 13. Measured $\|\text{Log Hol}\|$ vs. τ (analytic shapes). Generic pair: fitted slope 1.999 over $\tau \in [0.05, 1.6]$ s; the coefficient ratio $\|\text{Log Hol}\|/\tau^2 \| [C_i, C_j] \| = 1.0000$ at the smallest τ . Switch-off arms ($s_i=s_j$; $\eta=0$; $\xi=0$) sit at machine zero ($\xi=0$ literally 0.0) — the effect dies exactly when the theorem requires it to.

TABLE III
SWITCH-OFF LADDER (TIER-1 ROWS; EXECUTED VALUES).

arm	prediction	measured
generic slope	2	1.999
coefficient ratio ($m=2$)	1	1.0000
$s_i \equiv s_j$	0	$< 10^{-15}$
$\eta = 0$	0	$< 10^{-16}$
$\xi = 0$	0	0.0

mixture), and the robust suppression factor ($2.75\times$, short of the registered $10\times$: the protection is an amplitude-object property, degraded outside the uniform-delay protocol class). The C19 remainder row tripped in the *favorable* direction — the remainder vanishes faster than registered — and is drawn orange, as tripped, not green. This figure is the letter’s statistical integrity statement: the reader can see what was bet, what was won, and what was lost.

VI. CONTRIBUTION, DEDUCED

The chain closes as follows. Lemma 1 makes decentralized load estimation from purely local sensing well posed and supplies the transports; Lemma 2 shows any closed walk of stale transports is second-order in the staleness with a commutator coefficient; Theorem 1 identifies that coefficient with the constraint curvature through the conjugated generators and converts it into a frustration bound — the impossibility of exactly consistent decentralized estimation under latency and motion; and Corollary 1 plus the $\xi=0$, $\tau \rightarrow 0$ limits give the complete set of null directions. The measurements verify every element of this chain at its own level: order (1.999/2.000 on two independent constructions), coefficient (1.0000), and all null directions (machine zero). The main contribution is therefore not a bound alone but an *identified mechanism with verified constants and verified switch-offs* — together with the honest boundary of Sec. V: the conjectured stochastic extension of this mechanism to the noisy closed loop is measurably false at realistic noise, where first-order

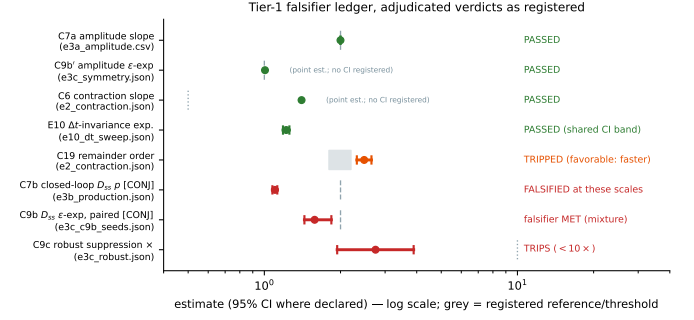


Fig. 14. The complete Tier-1 falsifier ledger, verdicts as registered. Green = passed; red = falsified / falsifier met ([CONJECTURAL] rows — measured slopes reported as measured, no law asserted); orange = tripped favorably (C19: the remainder vanishes *faster* than the registered second order). Grey dashes and bands are the registered references and thresholds; evidence file named per row.

TABLE IV
THEOREM-TO-EXPERIMENT CORRESPONDENCE (ASSUMPTION COLUMN: T = TAUT, ξ = COMMON TWIST, η = PERSISTENT TURN, U = UNIFORM LAG; TABLE II).

claim	assumes	measurement	figure/table	outcome
order (Thm 1)	2 T $\xi\eta$ U	log-log slope, 6 τ	Fig. 13, 12a	1.999 / 2.000 both plants
coefficient ($m=2$)	1 T $\xi\eta$ U	ratio at small τ	Fig. 13, 10	1.0000
null: $s_i=s_j$ (Cor. 1)	T $\xi\eta$ U	switch-off arm	ladder table	$< 10^{-15}$
null: $\eta=0$	T ξ U	switch-off arm	ladder table	$< 10^{-16}$
null: $\xi=0$	TU	switch-off arm	ladder table	exactly 0.0
null: $\tau=0$	T $\xi\eta$	explicit arm	Sec. III-E(iii)	exactly 0.0
$O(\tau^3)$ uniform sup	T $\xi\eta$ U	220-draw	Fig. 9	≤ 0.0133
level-set class	T ξ	C15 search + torus scan	Fig. 8	discrete; exact protection
domain boundary	T $\xi\eta$ U	large- τ arm	Fig. 11	10% at $\tau \approx 10$
D_{ss} ([CONJECTURAL]) $\mathcal{P}$'s noise-free premise	outside	companion E3b	Fig. 14	falsified at these scales

estimate mismatch dominates. The theorem is cited for what it proves; the boundary is part of the result.

Table IV closes the loop between statements and evidence: every claim in the theorem chain is mapped to its assumptions, its measurement, its figure, and its outcome. No claim in this letter lacks a row.

VII. SUPPLEMENTARY MOVIES

Three supplementary movies accompany the letter; each is generated by a seeded, versioned script and each carries a distinct piece of the argument.

S1 (holonomy_loop.mp4). The mechanism itself: a reference frame is carried around the four-leg loop $e^{\tau C_i} e^{\tau C_j} e^{-\tau C_i} e^{-\tau C_j}$ as τ grows from 0.02 to 1.6 s. The loop visibly fails to close; the closing gap is the holonomy, and the side panel traces its

TABLE V
REPRODUCIBILITY INVENTORY (COMPANION REPOSITORY).

artifact	source / regeneration
campaign records	tier1_sheaf/results/*.json,csv (committed)
figure generator	tier1_sheaf/campaign/paper_artifact.py (replays the draw sequence seed-exact and <i>asserts</i> it against the committed record before plotting)
movie generators	holonomy_movie.py, level_set_movie.py, formation_sweep_movie.py (seeded, deterministic)
extension driver	tier1_sheaf/campaign/e3a_extension.py (seed 2026; wrote the committed record)
replay harness	campaign_replay.py: per-cell probes must match committed records to 10^{-9} (exact class)
environment	requirements.lock.txt (pinned); no GPU required
seeds	every driver embeds its seeds; formation draws are id-keyed
availability	companion repository, released with the paper (archived tagged release with DOI at submission); reproduction commands in the root README

IX. REPRODUCIBILITY

Every number above traces to a seeded, versioned driver; `campaign_replay.py` in the companion repository re-executes per-run probes that must match committed records exactly. The figure generator for this letter additionally *re-derives* the 20-formation and 220-draw datasets at import time and refuses to plot if they do not match the committed campaign record to 10^{-12} — the figures cannot silently drift from the data.

amplitude along the τ^2 law. (Playback: 20 fps; the on-screen τ and gap are printed each frame.)

S2 (level_set.mp4). The discovery of arm (iv) as a side-by-side comparison under identical protocol: left, a generic pair — the loop opens quadratically; right, the discovered level-set pair 1.06 rad apart — the loop closes to 10^{-16} at *every* τ , with both amplitude traces running below. (Playback: 20 fps, 8 s; frames advance the staleness τ , not wall time.) One movie, two behaviors, one changed variable: the commutator.

S3 (formation_sweep.mp4). Formation invariance as a sweep: the exact 20-formation draw sequence of the campaign (replayed seed-exact and asserted against the persisted record) is shown formation by formation — geometry, per-formation fit, and the slope strip collapsing onto 1.9993 with 10^{-14} -scale spread. (Playback: 10 fps, 20 s; frames advance the formation index, not wall time.) The order is structural; the geometry moves only the coefficient.

VIII. RESEARCH-ARTIFACT PACKAGE

Beyond the figures and movies above, the letter ships as a structured evidence package; every item is generated by committed code from committed records. *Conceptual*: the problem/notation schematic and mechanism diagram (Fig. 2), the statement-dependency map (Fig. 4). *Formal*: notation (Table I), assumptions with violation consequences (Table II), theorem-to-experiment correspondence (Table IV). *Quantitative*: the amplitude law (Fig. 13), extension panels (Fig. 12), remainder distributions (Fig. 9), bound tightness (Fig. 10), domain boundary (Fig. 11), the global level-set map (Fig. 8), the switch-off ladder (table), and the adjudicated falsifier ledger (Fig. 14). *Multimedia*: movies S1–S3 with per-frame quantitative overlays. *Reproducibility*: Table V inventories the executable artifacts.